

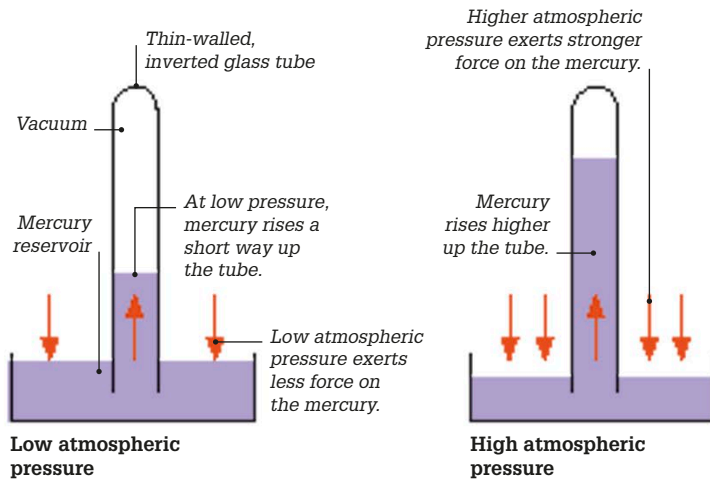
1643

The first barometer

When Italian physicist Evangelista Torricelli placed a glass tube filled with mercury in a bowl of mercury, the mercury in the tube fell, leaving a vacuum at the top. He realized this was due to atmospheric pressure (weight of air). Torricelli's discovery led to the invention of the barometer, an instrument that measures air pressure to forecast the weather.

Replica of
Torricelli's
barometer

How a barometer works



One of Hevelius's maps of the Moon

1647

Atlas of the Moon

Polish astronomer Johannes Hevelius published the first atlas of the Moon's surface. Hevelius, who was a brewer by trade, built his own observatory. His detailed maps showing the Moon's mountains and craters were the result of four years of observation.

1642

1642

Calculating machine

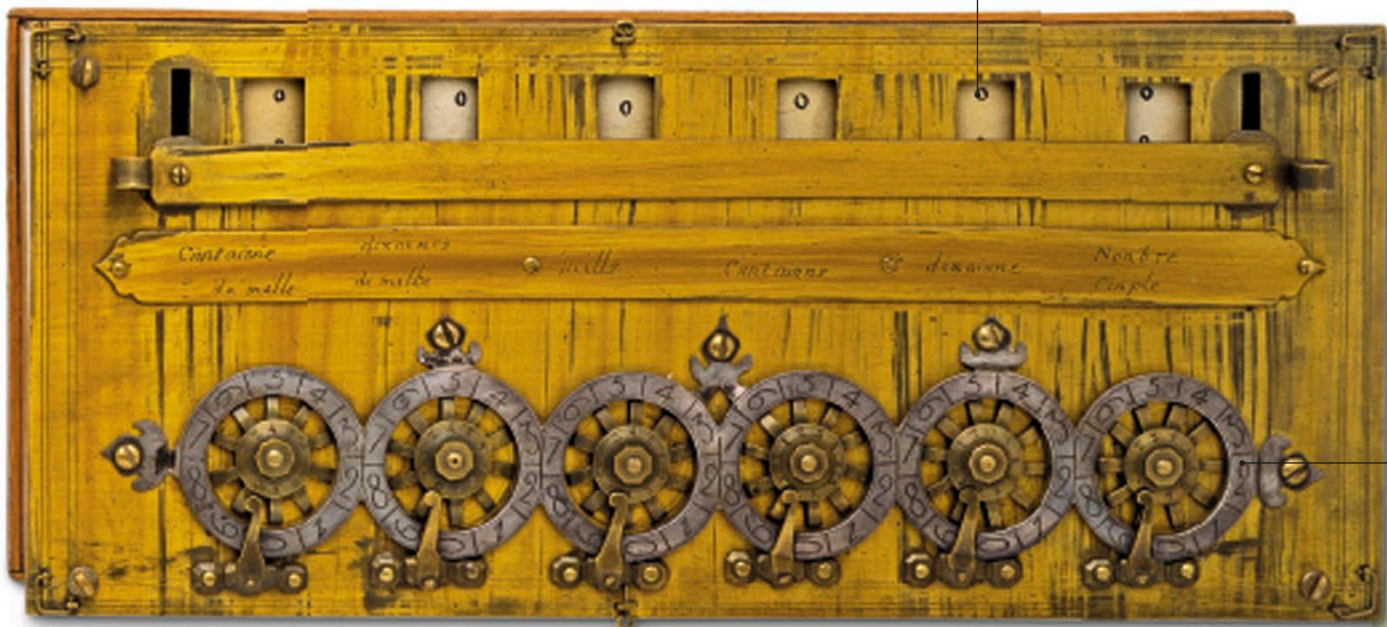
At the age of 19, Blaise Pascal invented a mechanical calculating machine to help his father, a French government tax collector. The machine could add, subtract, divide, and multiply. Pascal went on to become a leading mathematician and philosopher of the age.

Calculating
machines
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French scientist
Blaise Pascal built
about 20 calculators
in his lifetime.

Display windows
show answers

Pascal's first calculator



Dials for
inputting
numbers